ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** America to England	He is on a sea voyage across the Atlantic.
2	**(b)** ten o'clock sharp	A fixed time creates a countdown.
3	**(d)** the pigeons inside the box	It is harmless.
4	**(c)** Spartan	The narrator is aboard the Spartan.
5	**(a)** a bomb	He imagines the worst.
6	**(b)** surprise twist	Fear turns into humour.
7	**(c)** nervous	He is a nervous traveller.
8	**(d)** fears being questioned or laughed at	He doubts himself and fears ridicule.
9	**(c)** humour	The twist makes it funny.
10	**(c)** at the last minute	Their late arrival makes the narrator curious.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	From America to England (1) on the ship Spartan (1).	1+1
12	He feared being questioned or laughed at (1) in case he was wrong (1).	1+1
13	One of the men on the ship (1) whose pigeon reaches land first in the race (1).	1+1
14	They boarded at the last minute (1) and were secretive about a small square box (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A small square box (1). Dark wood, like a pistol case (1). It had a trigger-like arrangement and a coil of string (1).	1+1+1
16	Captains often dislike such events (1). The men hid the race for this reason (1). The secrecy fed the narrator's suspicions (1).	1+1+1
17	They are unexplained details (1). They match what the narrator fears (1). Readers share his suspicion (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Secretive men and clicking (1). A fixed time of ten o'clock (1). The narrator's countdown in the lifeboat (1).	1+1+1
18	Ten o'clock approaches (1). The narrator jumps out shouting 'Stop!' (1). The box opens and pigeons fly out (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The pigeons are well and ready (1). Their plan is going well (1). The narrator reads it as a villain's pleasure (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Narrator on the Spartan (1). Two men with a box board late (1). Suspicious clues: grains, clicking, ten o'clock (1). Hides in lifeboat, jumps out shouting (1). Pigeons fly out; the race (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Voyage and the men (1). His fears (1). The twist (1). His reflection (1).	2+2+1
20	Mysterious box (1). Secretive men and 'letting it off' (1). Clicking and grains (1). Countdown to ten o'clock (1). Humorous twist (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Where and when (1). The narrator's actions (1). What the box held (1). Closing quotes (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** in a lifeboat	He climbs into a lifeboat above the deck.
2	**(d)** overactive	He jumps to conclusions.
3	**(c)** a small square box	The box becomes the centre of the story.
4	**(b)** 'Stop!'	He tries to stop the 'explosion'.
5	**(a)** assuming the worst without checking	He jumps to conclusions.
6	**(d)** pistol case	He compares it to a pistol case.
7	**(c)** mad	They do not understand his panic.
8	**(a)** a judgment formed without proper knowledge	A bias.
9	**(b)** secretive	They guard it closely.
10	**(a)** pigeons	The box held racing birds.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	In a lifeboat above the deck (1) because he believed the explosion was about to happen (1).	1+1
12	Captains have a prejudice against such sports aboard ships (1), so they feared it would be stopped (1).	1+1
13	He thinks it holds a bomb (1) because of the clicking, the grains and the talk of 'letting it off' (1).	1+1
14	He jumped out of the lifeboat (1) and shouted 'Stop!' (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He feared being laughed at if wrong (1). He feared disaster if silent (1). Hence he hesitated and decided to watch (1).	1+1+1
16	Nervous and imaginative (1). Indecisive but cautious (1). Jumps to conclusions under stress (1).	1+1+1
17	Quietly inform the captain (1). Ask the men politely (1). Avoid panic and wait for facts (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He took the grains for explosive material (1). He took the clicking for a mechanism (1). He took 'letting it off' to mean an explosion (1).	1+1+1
18	Shocked (1). Embarrassed (1). Relieved that no one was in danger (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is the narrator's hiding place (1). It hangs over the deck, adding danger (1). He leaps from it, causing the climax (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Nervous (1). Imaginative (1). Indecisive about the captain (1). Jumps to conclusions (1). Embarrassed but relieved (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Imagination can magnify fear (1). The narrator builds a story from clues (1). He acts without checking (1). The result is comic (1). The need to question assumptions (1).	2+2+1
20	Sees box and secrecy (1). Hears clicking, sees grains (1). Thinks of telling the captain (1). Decides to wait (1). Hides in the lifeboat and jumps at ten (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Surprise and explanation (1). Narrator's apology (1). Flannigan's amusement (1). The secret race (1). The captain's prejudice (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | Class 8 English_Gulmohar | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** a small boat kept for emergencies	Used to save lives at sea.
2	**(d)** whitish grains	These grains look suspicious to the narrator.
3	**(b)** race	A pigeon race was secretly planned.
4	**(d)** counting backwards to an event	As time ticks away to ten o'clock.
5	**(c)** clicking	The clicking adds to his fear.
6	**(a)** Flannigan	Flannigan's pigeon wins.
7	**(d)** hides information	The men guard their plans.
8	**(d)** setting off an explosion	He assumes a bomb.
9	**(b)** captains have a prejudice against such sports aboard ships	The men fear the captain's disapproval.
10	**(b)** feeling that something is wrong	The narrator suspects danger.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It can lead to needless panic (1) and embarrassment (1).	1+1
12	Whitish grains (1), which the narrator took for bomb material (1).	1+1
13	Pigeons (1) kept for a race (1).	1+1
14	Secretive means hiding information (1). A suitable sentence (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He is terrified (1). He believes he will die (1). Every second seems endless (1).	1+1+1
16	The box is the centre of the plot (1). 'Little' makes it seem harmless (1). The twist shows how appearances deceive (1).	1+1+1
17	Suspense turns into humour (1). Fear becomes embarrassment (1). Readers smile at the narrator's mistake (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They are puzzled and think he is mad (1). They know the box holds pigeons (1). The contrast with his terror is comic (1).	1+1+1
18	Do not jump to conclusions (1). Check the facts first (1). Panic can lead to embarrassment (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It is one of the racing birds (1). It reaches land first (1). It decides the winner of the secret race (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Box looks like a pistol case (1). Men look like plotters (1). Contents are pigeons (1). Narrator misjudges (1). Lesson: verify facts (1).	2+2+1
	OR: A ship at sea (1). Isolation makes danger feel real (1). Lifeboat and deck add detail (1). The limited space heightens tension (1). The ending is comic by contrast (1).	2+2+1
20	Contrast between the narrator's terror and the men's calm (1). The twist of pigeons (1). Exaggerated fears (1). Comic embarrassment (1). Light ending (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Narrator's hesitant start (1). Captain's questions (1). Reveal of the race (1). Captain's reaction (1). Closing note of humour (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.